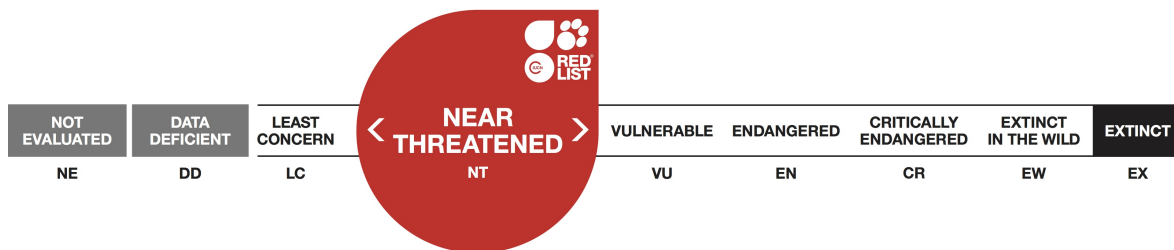


Litocranius walleri, Gerenuk

Assessment by: IUCN SSC Antelope Specialist Group



View on www.iucnredlist.org

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Taxonomy

Kingdom	Phylum	Class	Order	Family
Animalia	Chordata	Mammalia	Cetartiodactyla	Bovidae

Taxon Name: *Litocranius walleri* (Brooke, 1879)

Common Name(s):

- English: Gerenuk
- French: Gazelle de Waller, Gazelle-Giraffe

Taxonomic Notes:

Two subspecies have been named for *Litocranius walleri*: the southern *L. w. walleri* and the larger northern *L. w. sclateri* (see Grubb 2002). The boundary between the two named forms is not clearly defined. Only the species is assessed here.

Assessment Information

Red List Category & Criteria: Near Threatened [ver 3.1](#)

Year Published: 2016

Date Assessed: April 20, 2016

Justification:

The Gerenuk is estimated to be close to meeting the threshold for Vulnerable under criterion A2cd, based on a decline of at least 25% over the last 14 years (three generations) calculated from 2002-2016. This decline is continuing due to hunting and habitat degradation caused by livestock grazing and cutting of trees.

Previously Published Red List Assessments

2008 – Near Threatened (NT) – <http://dx.doi.org/10.2305/IUCN.UK.2008.RLTS.T12142A3325148.en>

1996 – Lower Risk/conservation dependent (LR/cd)

Geographic Range

Range Description:

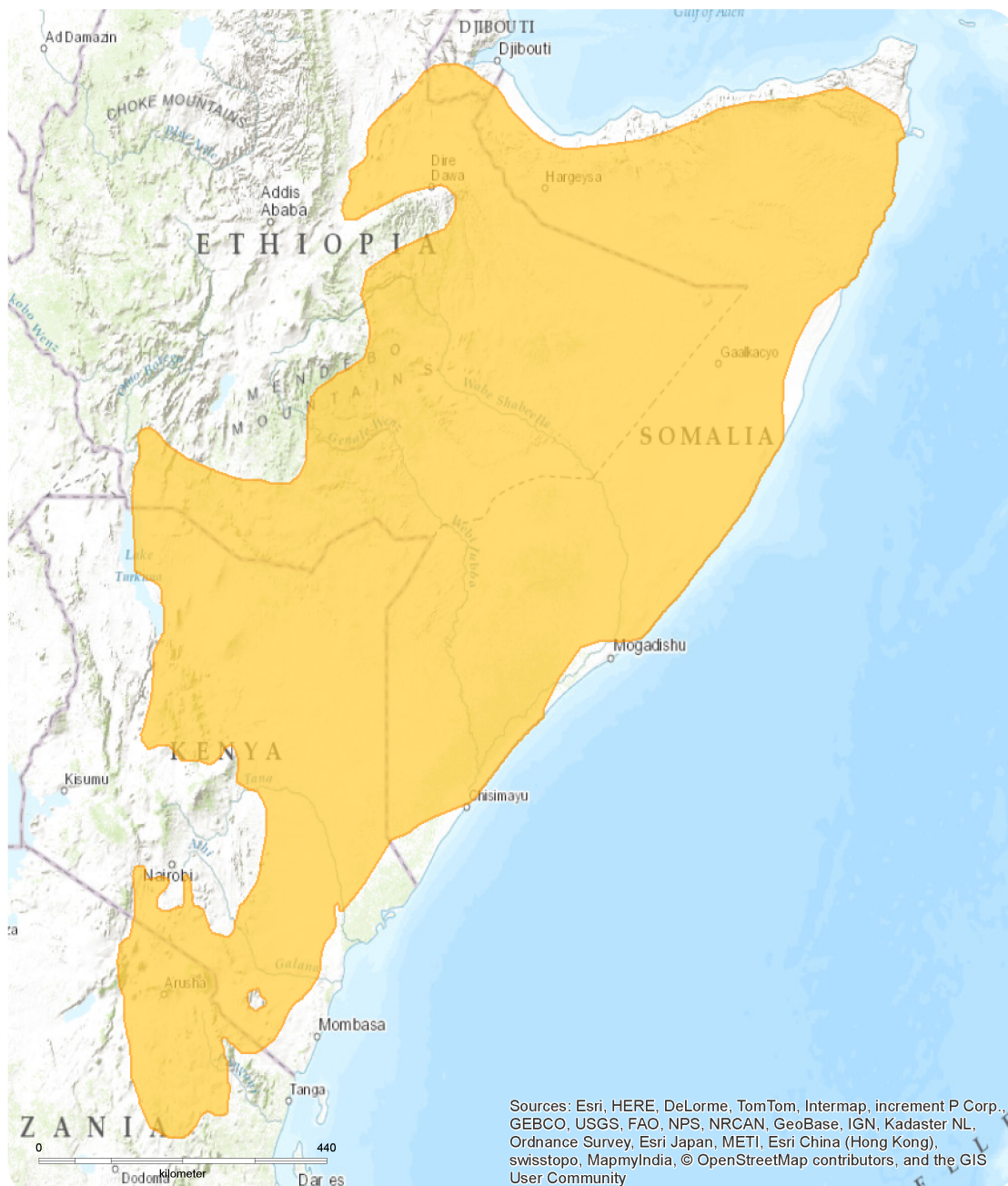
The Gerenuk (*Litocranius walleri*) formerly occurred widely in the semi-arid bushland of north-east Africa, from southern Djibouti to north-east Tanzania. The northern limit of the range is about 11°30'N in Djibouti (Laurent and Laurent 2002) and the southern limit around Tarangire National Park (NP) in Tanzania (Leuthold 2013). The Gerenuk still occupies large parts of its historical range. It was described as the commonest and most widespread antelope species across Somalia by Funaoli and Simonetta (1966) but little recent information is available on its current distribution there and it was expected to have been severely reduced (East 1999). The species remains widely but thinly spread in Somaliland, northern Somalia (Mallon and Jama 2013).

Country Occurrence:

Native: Djibouti; Ethiopia; Kenya; Somalia; Tanzania, United Republic of

Distribution Map

Litocranius walleri

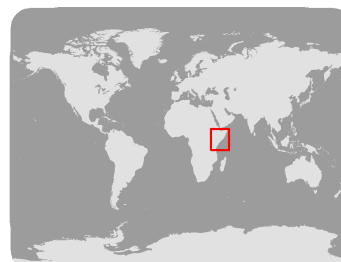


Litocranius walleri

Range

Extant (resident)

Compiled by:
IUCN (International Union for
Conservation of Nature)



The boundaries and names shown and the designations used on this map do not imply any official endorsement, acceptance or opinion by IUCN.



Population

East (1999) estimated the population at 24,000, based on aerial counts and revised that figure to 95,000 to account for under-counting bias in aerial surveys. The species is difficult to census both from the ground and especially from the air, due to its often dense bush habitats, small group size and cryptic colouration (Leuthold 2013). Density estimates range from a maximum of 0.2/km² on aerial surveys to 1.0/km² from road counts and up to 8.0/km² in particularly favourable habitats, such as Samburu G.R. in Kenya (Leuthold 2013). East (1999) estimated that only 10% occurred in protected areas. The largest surviving populations occur in south-western Ethiopia and the northern and eastern rangelands of Kenya. Population trend may be generally stable in protected areas, with a few exceptions such as the declining population of Tsavo National Park, and slowly decreasing elsewhere. East (1999) suggested a 50% decline in Kenya since 1970. In Tanzania, Gerenuks remain common in the Lake Natron area and fairly common in West Kilimanjaro, but have declined in the Makame depression in recent years because of over-hunting (Foley *et al.* 2014).

Current Population Trend: Decreasing

Habitat and Ecology (see Appendix for additional information)

Inhabits bushland, thickets, semi-arid and arid thornbush (below 1,600 m), avoiding dense woodlands and very open, grass-dominated habitats. One of the most exclusive browsers, Gerenuk are largely independent of water (Leuthold 2013).

Systems: Terrestrial

Use and Trade

This species is hunted for meat but levels of offtake are unknown.

Threats (see Appendix for additional information)

The Gerenuk can withstand hunting pressures to some degree which has enabled it to survive widely in regions such as the Ogaden in the complete absence of protection. Its habitat is subject to encroachment by increasing numbers of pastoralists and cutting of trees for firewood and charcoal. Civil conflicts, wars and unrest have affected much of the range in Somalia and the Ogaden over recent decades. If current trends continue, it may eventually disappear from large parts of its present distribution until it is largely restricted to effectively protected and managed areas of suitable habitat. Such areas currently comprise only a small part of its remaining range. The largest protected population, in Tsavo National Park, has been reduced by rinderpest and drought (East 1999). Agricultural expansion, for example in the southern Masai steppe is encroaching on their habitat, but most of Gerenuk's range is too arid to support agriculture (Foley *et al.* 2014).

Conservation Actions (see Appendix for additional information)

About 10% of the population occurs in protected areas (East 1999). Important protected area populations occur in Mago NP and Awash NP (Ethiopia), Sibiloi, Tsavo and Meru National Parks and Samburu Game Reserve (Kenya) and Mkomazi Game Reserve and Tarangire NP (Tanzania). It can be favoured by the spread of thickets following overgrazing by grasslands by livestock or removal of elephants by poaching.

Credits

Assessor(s): IUCN SSC Antelope Specialist Group

Reviewer(s): Hoffmann, M.

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External Resources

For [Images and External Links to Additional Information](#), please see the Red List website.

Appendix

Habitats

(<http://www.iucnredlist.org/technical-documents/classification-schemes>)

Habitat	Season	Suitability	Major Importance?
2. Savanna -> 2.1. Savanna - Dry	Resident	Marginal	-
3. Shrubland -> 3.5. Shrubland - Subtropical/Tropical Dry	Resident	Suitable	Yes

Threats

(<http://www.iucnredlist.org/technical-documents/classification-schemes>)

Threat	Timing	Scope	Severity	Impact Score
2. Agriculture & aquaculture -> 2.3. Livestock farming & ranching -> 2.3.4. Scale Unknown/Unrecorded	Ongoing	Majority (50-90%)	Slow, significant declines	Medium impact: 6
	Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.1. Ecosystem conversion 1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.2. Ecosystem degradation		
5. Biological resource use -> 5.1. Hunting & trapping terrestrial animals -> 5.1.1. Intentional use (species is the target)	Ongoing	Majority (50-90%)	Slow, significant declines	Medium impact: 6
	Stresses:	2. Species Stresses -> 2.1. Species mortality		
5. Biological resource use -> 5.3. Logging & wood harvesting -> 5.3.3. Unintentional effects: (subsistence/small scale) [harvest]	Ongoing	Majority (50-90%)	Unknown	Unknown
	Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.1. Ecosystem conversion 2. Species Stresses -> 2.2. Species disturbance		
6. Human intrusions & disturbance -> 6.2. War, civil unrest & military exercises	Ongoing	Minority (50%)	Unknown	Unknown
	Stresses:	2. Species Stresses -> 2.2. Species disturbance		

Conservation Actions in Place

(<http://www.iucnredlist.org/technical-documents/classification-schemes>)

Conservation Actions in Place
In-Place Research, Monitoring and Planning
Action Recovery plan: No
Systematic monitoring scheme: No
In-Place Land/Water Protection and Management
Conservation sites identified: Yes, over entire range
Occur in at least one PA: Yes

Conservation Actions in Place
Percentage of population protected by PAs (0-100): 1-10
Area based regional management plan: No
In-Place Species Management
Successfully reintroduced or introduced benignly: No
In-Place Education
Included in international legislation: No
Subject to any international management/trade controls: No

Conservation Actions Needed

(<http://www.iucnredlist.org/technical-documents/classification-schemes>)

Conservation Actions Needed
1. Land/water protection -> 1.1. Site/area protection
2. Land/water management -> 2.1. Site/area management

Research Needed

(<http://www.iucnredlist.org/technical-documents/classification-schemes>)

Research Needed
1. Research -> 1.2. Population size, distribution & trends
1. Research -> 1.5. Threats
3. Monitoring -> 3.1. Population trends

Additional Data Fields

Distribution
Lower elevation limit (m): 0
Upper elevation limit (m): 1600
Population
Population severely fragmented: No
Habitats and Ecology
Generation Length (years): 4.6

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